



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*tattvavijñānasandaṁśamādāya hṛdayodarāt |
nānāvidhaparāmarśaśalyoddhāraḥ kṛto mayā || 19 | 1 | |
kva dharmāḥ kva ca vā kāmāḥ kva cārthāḥ kva vivekatā |
kva dvaitaṁ kva ca vā+advaitaṁ svamahimni sthitasya me || 19 | 2 | |*

— Aṣṭāvakragītā, Prakaraṇa 19 (Chapter 19), Verses 1-2

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

With the tweezers of true knowledge, I have extracted from the depths of my heart the thorns of varied opinions. These powerful verses mark a turning point, a declaration of liberation achieved. Ashtavakra, the enlightened sage, speaks here of a profound inner surgery. He has used the sharp instrument of *tattva-vijñana*, the direct realization of Truth, to meticulously remove the *shalyas*, the painful splinters of countless beliefs and mental constructs that were lodged within his being. These "thorns" represent the endless debates, the clinging to viewpoints, and the anxieties that plague the unenlightened mind. He is free from the burden of intellectual concepts.

Having performed this inner purification, Ashtavakra then proclaims a state of being beyond the ordinary concerns of human existence. Where now is dharma, the righteous path? Where is kama, desire? Where is artha, material wealth? Where is viveka, discrimination? Where is duality? Where is non-duality? All these lose their significance for one established in their own true glory, *svamahimni sthitasya me*. He resides in the Self, which transcends all these relative concepts. He is no longer bound by the pursuit of virtue, the fulfillment of desires, or the accumulation of possessions. Even the intellectual understanding of duality and non-duality becomes irrelevant because he lives it.

This freedom isn't just for ancient sages. It speaks directly to your own struggles in today's complex world. You are constantly bombarded with opinions, choices, and demands. The pursuit of success, relationships, and material comfort can leave you feeling fragmented and unfulfilled. This verse invites you to examine the "thorns" that are lodged within your own heart: the limiting beliefs, the anxieties, the attachments that keep you from experiencing your true self. Just as Ashtavakra used the tool of knowledge to extract these thorns, you too can use self-awareness and introspection to identify and release the beliefs that no longer serve you. Discover your own inherent magnificence.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

What "thorns" of limiting beliefs or attachments are you ready to extract from your heart today to experience greater freedom and peace?